

CANDIDATE ELIMINATION ALGORITHM

AIM:

To implement the **Candidate Elimination Algorithm** for learning a target concept and to determine the **Specific Boundary (S)** and **General Boundary (G)** of the version space using given training examples.

CANDIDATE ELIMINATION ALGORITHM (CONCEPT)

Candidate Elimination is a **concept learning algorithm** that maintains a **version space**, which is the set of all hypotheses consistent with the training data.

It maintains two boundaries:

Specific Boundary (S):

The most specific hypothesis that fits all positive examples.

General Boundary (G):

The most general hypotheses that do not cover any negative examples.

The algorithm iteratively updates S and G as new training examples are processed.

ALGORITHM (STEPS)

1. Initialize:
 - Specific hypothesis **S** with the most specific values ($\emptyset$).
 - General hypothesis **G** with the most general values (?).
2. For each training example:
 - If the example is **positive**:
 - Generalize S minimally to include the example.
 - Remove hypotheses from G that do not cover the example.
 - If the example is **negative**:
 - Specialize G minimally to exclude the example.
 - Remove hypotheses that are inconsistent or redundant.
3. Prune G to keep only **maximally general hypotheses**.
4. Continue until all examples are processed.
5. The final S and G define the **version space**.

Intelligent System for Remote Work Approval

Problem Overview

A startup wants to decide whether an employee should be approved for **Remote Work** based on the following attributes:

1. **Role** – Technical / Non-Technical
2. **Experience** – Junior / Senior
3. **Performance** – Average / Excellent
4. **Internet Quality** – Poor / Good
5. **Work Location** – Urban / Rural

Target Concept: RemoteWorkApproval = Yes / No

Training Examples

No	Role	Experience	Performance	Internet	Location	Approval
1	Technical	Senior	Excellent	Good	Urban	Yes
2	Technical	Junior	Excellent	Good	Urban	Yes
3	Non-Technical	Junior	Average	Poor	Rural	No
4	Technical	Senior	Average	Good	Rural	No
5	Technical	Senior	Excellent	Good	Rural	Yes

Q1. Initialization

a) Initial Hypotheses

Most Specific Hypothesis (S_0):

[$\langle \emptyset, \emptyset, \emptyset, \emptyset, \emptyset \rangle$]

Most General Hypothesis (G_0):

[$\langle ?, ?, ?, ?, ? \rangle$]

b) Why These Are Chosen

S_0 represents *no knowledge* and matches **no instances**.

G_0 represents *maximum generality* and matches **all instances**.

Candidate Elimination shrinks the version space from both ends using data.

Q2. Step-by-Step Learning (Candidate Elimination Algorithm)

Example 1 (Positive)

$\langle \text{Technical, Senior, Excellent, Good, Urban} \rangle \rightarrow \text{Yes}$

Update S to match the example

G remains unchanged

S: $\langle \text{Technical, Senior, Excellent, Good, Urban} \rangle$

G: $\langle ?, ?, ?, ?, ? \rangle$

Example 2 (Positive)

$\langle \text{Technical, Junior, Excellent, Good, Urban} \rangle \rightarrow \text{Yes}$

Generalize S where values differ

S: $\langle \text{Technical, ?, Excellent, Good, Urban} \rangle$

G: $\langle ?, ?, ?, ?, ? \rangle$

Example 3 (Negative)

$\langle \text{Non-Technical, Junior, Average, Poor, Rural} \rangle \rightarrow \text{No}$

S unchanged (does not cover negative example)

Specialize G to exclude this negative example

G:

$\langle \text{Technical, ?, ?, ?, ?} \rangle$

$\langle ?, ?, \text{Excellent}, ?, ? \rangle$

$\langle ?, ?, ?, \text{Good}, ? \rangle$

$\langle ?, ?, ?, ?, \text{Urban} \rangle$

S: $\langle \text{Technical, ?, Excellent, Good, Urban} \rangle$

Example 4 (Negative)

$\langle \text{Technical, Senior, Average, Good, Rural} \rangle \rightarrow \text{No}$

Remove hypotheses in G that cover this negative example

Remaining G:

$\langle ?, ?, \text{Excellent}, ?, ? \rangle$

$\langle ?, ?, ?, ?, \text{Urban} \rangle$

S: unchanged

Example 5 (Positive)

$\langle \text{Technical, Senior, Excellent, Good, Rural} \rangle \rightarrow \text{Yes}$

Generalize S minimally

Remove inconsistent hypotheses from G
Final S: ⟨Technical, ?, Excellent, Good, ?⟩
Final G: ⟨?, ?, Excellent, ?, ?⟩

Q3. Version Space Analysis

a) Meaning of Final Version Space

The final version space contains **all hypotheses** that:
Approve remote work **only** for employees with *Excellent performance*
Are consistent with all given training examples

b) Two Valid Hypotheses in the Version Space

⟨Technical, ?, Excellent, Good, ?⟩
⟨?, ?, Excellent, ?, ?⟩

Q4. Prediction

Test Instance

⟨Technical, Senior, Excellent, Good, Urban⟩
Covered by S and G

Prediction

☒ **Remote Work Approved (Yes)**

Justification:

The instance satisfies the necessary condition $Performance = Excellent$ and is consistent with both boundaries.

Q5. Conceptual Understanding

a) Effect of Contradictory Examples

Version space may become **empty**
Indicates inconsistent or incorrect data

b) Handling Noisy Data

Candidate Elimination **cannot handle noise**
Requires all examples to be perfectly consistent

Q6. Critical Thinking

a) Real-World Limitation

Requires **complete and noise-free data**, which is unrealistic in HR decisions

b) Alternative Approach

Decision Trees (ID3 / C4.5) or **Naïve Bayes**
These handle noise and uncertainty better

Q7. Extension: Adding a New Attribute

New Attribute

Team Dependency – Low / High

Impact on Hypothesis Representation

Hypothesis size increases from 5 to **6 attributes**

⟨Role, Experience, Performance, Internet, Location, Team Dependency⟩

Version space increases exponentially

CODE:

num attributes=5

$$G = [["?"] * \text{num_attributes}]$$

for h,e in zip(hypothesis,example):

```

return False

```

```
def more_general(h1,h2):
```

```
if x!="?" and (y=="?" or x!=y):
```

```
return True
```

pruned=[]

if not any(more_general(other,g) and other!=g for other in G):

```

1
return pruned

```

```
print(f"\nExample {index}: {example} -> {label}")
```

```
for i in range(num_attributes):
```

```
S[i]=example[i]
```

```
S[i]="?"
```

$$G = [g \text{ for } g \text{ in } G \text{ if is_consistent}(g, \text{example})]$$

```
new G=[]
```

for g in G :

if is_consistent(g,example):

```
for i in range(num_attributes):
```

```

if g[i]=="?":

```

```

if S[i]!="?" and S[i]!=example[i]:

```

```
new_hypothesis=g.copy()
```

```
new_hypothesis = greedy
new_hypothesis[i]=S[i]
```

```
new_hypothesis[X] = S[X]
new G.append(new hypothesis)
```

```

        else:
            new_G.append(g)
        G=new_G
        G=prune_G(G)
        print("Specific Boundary S:",S)
        print("General Boundary G:",G)
    print("\nFINAL RESULT")
    print("Final Specific Hypothesis (S):",S)
    print("Final General Hypotheses (G):",G)

```

Observation	15	
Implementation	35	
Output	10	
Viva	10	
Record	05	
Total	75	

RESULT:

Thus implement the **Candidate Elimination Algorithm** for learning a target concept and to determine the **Specific Boundary (S)** and **General Boundary (G)** of the version space and uploaded in Github

Github link:

[VarshiniRamesh2005/machine-learning](https://github.com/VarshiniRamesh2005/machine-learning)

OUTPUT:

Example 1: ['Technical', 'Senior', 'Excellent', 'Good', 'Urban'] -> Yes
Specific Boundary S: ['Technical', 'Senior', 'Excellent', 'Good', 'Urban']
General Boundary G: [['?', '?', '?', '?', '?']]

Example 2: ['Technical', 'Junior', 'Excellent', 'Good', 'Urban'] -> Yes
Specific Boundary S: ['Technical', '?', 'Excellent', 'Good', 'Urban']
General Boundary G: [['?', '?', '?', '?', '?']]

Example 3: ['Non-Technical', 'Junior', 'Average', 'Poor', 'Rural'] -> No
Specific Boundary S: ['Technical', '?', 'Excellent', 'Good', 'Urban']
General Boundary G: [['Technical', '?', '?', '?', '?'], ['?', '?', 'Excellent', '?', '?'], ['?', '?', '?', 'Good', '?'], ['?', '?', '?', '?', 'Urban']]

Example 4: ['Technical', 'Senior', 'Average', 'Good', 'Rural'] -> No
Specific Boundary S: ['Technical', '?', 'Excellent', 'Good', 'Urban']
General Boundary G: [['?', '?', 'Excellent', '?', '?'], ['?', '?', '?', '?', 'Urban']]

Example 5: ['Technical', 'Senior', 'Excellent', 'Good', 'Rural'] -> Yes
Specific Boundary S: ['Technical', '?', 'Excellent', 'Good', '?']
General Boundary G: [['?', '?', 'Excellent', '?', '?']]

FINAL RESULT

Final Specific Hypothesis (S): ['Technical', '?', 'Excellent', 'Good', '?']
Final General Hypotheses (G): [['?', '?', 'Excellent', '?', '?']]